

CORE FORMULA

Permission or context + clean win + honest feeling + proportionate context + release. -> Can I share a win? I got the fellowship. I am really pleased because it was a long process. -> Good news: the launch landed well. I am proud of the team and relieved the preparation paid off. -> I got invited to speak at the conference. I am excited and a little nervous. -> The client renewed. I am glad the work created enough trust to continue.

MINIMUM VIABLE MOVE

I have a win to share: [specific win]. I am pleased about it.

BEST FOR

- Sharing good news with friends, colleagues, family, or an online audience
- Updating others on a promotion, award, acceptance, media mention, result, or growing demand
- Performance reviews, interviews, portfolios, bios, and introductions
- Moments where you feel tempted to soften a win with complaint or false modesty
- High-status achievements that could crowd the room if handled carelessly

PHRASE BANK

Quick openers · Short win-share starters

- "I have a win to share: I got the offer."
- "Good news: it went well."
- "Can I share something good?"
- "I am proud of this one."
- "Small win — I wanted to tell you directly."
- "This meant a lot to me."
- "I will keep it short: it landed well."
- "Quick bit of good news, if you have a second."

With people close to you · Warm, simple disclosure

- "I wanted to tell you directly: I got accepted. I am really happy about it."
- "There is good news in my week, and I wanted to share it with you."
- "I am grateful, and still taking it in."
- "It means a lot, and I wanted you to be one of the first to know."
- "I am really pleased about this, and I wanted to share it with you specifically."
- "This one mattered to me, so I wanted to say it out loud."

Work and updates · Factual, credit-aware

- "The project landed well with the client. I am glad the work was useful."
- "The presentation landed well, and people have asked for the deck."
- "I am pleased with the recognition, and it reflects the group effort behind it."
- "Good update: the article is out today. I am grateful to everyone who shaped it."
- "I want to credit the team for the prep — it made the difference."
- "The client renewed. I am glad the work created enough trust to continue."

Answering and advocating · Direct answers, reviews, interviews

- "Yes, it went well. I am proud of the result, and I am still taking in what it means."
- "The rollout reduced rework, and I learned that earlier stakeholder checks matter."

- "I am proud of the work, and I can own it without inflating it."
- "Here is the evidence, the impact, and what I would do differently."
- "I am not fishing for reassurance; I just wanted to share the update plainly."
- "I got the role. I am pleased, and I want to be clear about what I contributed."

Cleaning it up mid-share · Softening and self-correction

- "That sounded more like a humblebrag than I intended. Cleaner version: I am happy about it."
- "Let me say that without the cover: I got the opportunity, and I am grateful."
- "I do not want to make you manage my modesty — I am just pleased about it."
- "I framed that as a complaint, but it is genuinely good news."
- "I will pause there; I do not need you to reassure me."

Returning the floor · Release and hand back

- "Thanks for letting me share that. What has been going well on your side?"
- "That is the short version — how has your week been?"
- "The credit is shared. I would love to hear how your project is going."
- "No need to make a big thing of it; I just wanted to share the news."
- "That is my update — enough about me. What is new with you?"

When the moment is crowded · Sharing near someone else's news

- "That is excellent — you worked hard for it. I have a related update too, but I want to hear your story first."
- "I have some good news as well, though now is your moment, not mine."
- "I will hold my news for later; today is about yours."
- "If it is welcome, I have a small win too — but only if you have space for it."
- "I do not want my update to crowd the room, so I will keep it brief."

WEAK -> BETTER -> BEST

- Weak: Ugh, now I have to deal with all these congrats messages.
Better: I got promoted, which is good news, though the attention feels a bit odd.
Best: I got promoted. I am pleased and still adjusting to the attention. Thanks for letting me share it.
- Weak: Apparently my presentation was amazing and now everyone wants the deck.
Better: The presentation landed well and people have asked for the deck.
Best: The presentation landed well. I am glad it helped, and I am sending the deck round for anyone who wants it.
- Weak: I hate being too booked because people keep asking me to lead things.
Better: I have had more requests lately, which is flattering and hard to manage.
Best: I am getting more requests lately. I am grateful for the trust, and I need to be selective with my time.
- Weak: So embarrassing, they put my award photo everywhere.
Better: They shared the award photo publicly, which feels exposed but also meaningful.
Best: The award photo is public now. I feel a bit exposed, but I am proud of the work behind it.

DECISION TREE

If Is this actually good news or status-relevant information?

If not, drop the frame and say the real issue plainly. If yes, continue.

If Does this moment belong to someone else's news?

If yes, celebrate theirs and wait — this is a no-one-upping moment. If no, continue.

"That is excellent. I want to hear your story first."

If Am I tempted to frame the win as a complaint, embarrassment, or burden?

Strip the cover and state the win directly.

"Cleaner version: I got the role, and I am pleased."

If Is the listener available and in the right mode for this?

If not, save it or shorten it to one line. If yes, share cleanly.

"I have a win to share: [win]. I am [feeling] because [context]."

If How is the listener responding?

Engaged: add one concrete line. Thin response: thank them and move on. Discomfort: recover and return focus.
"Thanks — that is the short version. How about you?"

If Am I still waiting for admiration?

If yes, stop expanding; if you need support, ask for it honestly and separately. If no, carry on normally.
"I am not fishing for reassurance; I just wanted to share it."

SCENARIOS

Friend catch-up

Ask for room, state the win, add one line of meaning, then return the floor to them. — "Can I share a win? I got the grant. I am proud because it was a long process. What has been good on your side?"

Team meeting

Give the result, name the specific contribution, and credit accurately without erasing yourself. — "The client response was strong. I am pleased with the outcome, and the prep from Priya and Leo made the difference."

Networking post

Use direct good-news language with gratitude and context; skip the complaint cover and the word "humbled". — "Good news: the paper is live. I am grateful to the reviewers and collaborators who strengthened it."

After someone else's success

Celebrate theirs first; add your related news only if it is clearly invited or relevant. — "That is excellent — you worked hard for it. I have a related update too, but I want to hear your story first."

Performance review

State evidence, impact, and learning without apology or false modesty. — "The rollout reduced rework by 18 percent. I am proud of the result, and I learned that earlier stakeholder checks matter."

Family or old friends

Use warm, simple disclosure and make no demand for admiration. — "I wanted to tell you directly: I got accepted. I am really happy about it."

WHEN NOT TO USE

- Someone else is currently sharing vulnerable news or their own win
- The win is irrelevant to the relationship or the situation
- The listener is distressed, hurried, or not really available
- You are using the share to punish, compare, recruit envy, or fish for reassurance
- The disclosure would breach confidentiality or someone else's privacy
- You cannot yet share the news without turning it into a status contest

7-DAY PRACTICE DRILL

Day 1 — Spot the cover

Write down five humblebrag-style sentences you have said or heard, e.g. "It is so annoying that everyone keeps asking for my advice." Underline the hidden win in each.

Day 2 — Convert to clean

Rewrite each of yesterday's sentences as: "I have a win to share: [win]. I am [feeling] because [context]." Cut any comparison, superiority, or reassurance bait.

Day 3 — One-breath share

Take one real recent win and say it aloud in a single breath — event, feeling, one context line, stop. Notice the urge to keep justifying, and resist it.

Day 4 — Add the release

Practise ending each clean share with a genuine return line, e.g. "That is the short version — how has your week been?" Keep it only if it feels real, not like a social tax.

Day 5 — Recovery reps

Rehearse three repairs out loud, e.g. "That came out like a humblebrag — cleaner version: I am happy about it." Practise naming the miss once and then stopping.

Day 6 — Read the room

For five situations (a concrete follow-up, a flat "nice", someone sharing their own news, a genuine question, you waiting for praise), decide in advance: continue, shorten, or stop.

Day 7 — Share it for real

In a real conversation, share one genuine win using win + feeling + one context line, then hand the floor back. Score it 0–5: concrete win, honest feeling, no complaint cover, no comparison, ending releases pressure.

AFTER-ACTION CHECKLIST

- Did I state the achievement plainly, without hiding it in complaint, fake modesty, or embarrassment?
- Was the share proportionate to the relationship and the moment?
- Did I add only true credit and useful context — no comparison or superiority?
- Did I avoid making the listener reassure me or supply admiration?
- Did I stop after the clean share unless they invited more, and return focus genuinely?
- Would the sentence still feel respectful if the listener had not praised me back?